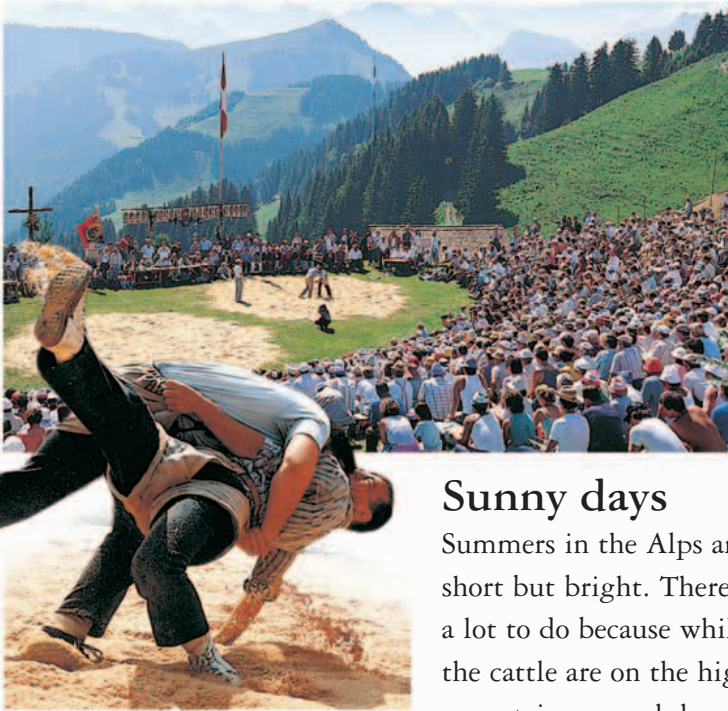




WRESTLING CONTEST

Schwingen is a style of wrestling that originated with Swiss farmers in the Alps. Today, *schwingen* is a popular sport in Switzerland, and the national championships that take place every three years are watched by more than 40,000 people.

Sunny days

Summers in the Alps are short but bright. There is a lot to do because while the cattle are on the high mountains enough hay must be prepared for the winter. Locals enjoy the good weather, as do tourists who visit at this time when the hills are green and perfect for hiking.



Traditionally, only boys took part in the *Chalandamarz*, but now girls join in too.



Information about every single cow in Switzerland is kept on a central computer.

COW BEAUTY CONTEST

In April, independent experts spend a day in each village judging the cows and establishing the value of each one. This day is critical so farmers spend a lot of time preparing for it. Each cow is scrubbed with warm, soapy water, its hooves are clipped, and it is made to parade in front of the judges.